

and hierarchy means that you could fall prey to stagnancy. You may have enjoyed the transition from 'corporate slave' to 'cool and carefree freelancer' but you do not want to get stuck at the same pay range forever.

When do you decide to evolve and increase your rates or expand your pool of clients? An easy and sureshot indicator for a higher payout is if you have recently upgraded your skill pool. If you have spent time and money educating yourself with a higher degree or diploma or specialised course, it should be reason enough to alter your payout.

You could also consider collaborating with other freelancers to help increase your cumulative worth. The kind of clients you can go after as a team would also mean bigger money for everyone involved. You could also outsource part of your work to other freelancers, and thus take on more work and expand your portfolio without really creating a team to handle.



Keep improving your skill set which will allow you to command a premium price

### **Strap in and enjoy the ride:**

While being a freelancer may have its pitfalls, the payouts are also great. If you learn how to juggle deadlines and finances, you might have a career path that will give you everything you were left wishing for in your last corporate job. It's not going to be a bed of roses, but it sure as hell won't be a path of thorns all the way along either. If you manage to work through the bad months and enjoy the good months, you will have enough left in the bank to make those dreams come true. All of this with the freedom of being your own boss. Hey! Who said good things only come to those who wait? They definitely come to those who get out there and work their way towards getting things done. **d**